

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Owner for complex transport and AI systems.*

Positioning, experienced Product Manager with a decade of structured requirements engineering and SAFe-adjacent delivery, ready to build greenfield scheduling platforms from the ground up.

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§ WHY SOTALENT

Greenfield platform work inside a newly forming Agile Release Train, with a scope that is still evolving and AI integration as an explicit goal – that combination is precisely the environment where the gap between a Product Owner who can hold their own technically and one who cannot becomes decisive. The posting calls for someone who can convert fuzzy business needs into structured Epics and Features while managing dependencies across multiple product teams in a public-sector context, which mirrors what I did at Rohde & Schwarz within the FCAS defence programme: politically sensitive, multinational, architecturally complex, and with no established baseline to copy from. A logistics specialisation from my Diplom at TU Berlin also means transport system domain vocabulary is not new territory for me. *That is exactly the environment where structured ambiguity-resolution compounds.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked inside a Deutsche Bahn or equivalent heavy-rail timetable system, so the domain-specific scheduling data models will be a learning curve in the first weeks. What I do bring is a proven mechanic for precisely that situation: taking incomplete, cross-stakeholder input and producing dev-ready structures quickly, demonstrated on an AI data platform for a European defence programme and a public analytics platform for the Federal Employment Agency.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements synthesis and edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication drafts and story templates
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo implementation support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, assisted development and spec review
- **Lovable**, rapid UI prototyping before stories hit the backlog
- **Gamma.app**, roadmap and PI planning visualisations
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and process mapping
- **Framer**, design-heavy stakeholder-facing mock-ups

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, GitOps, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, Bitbucket, Git, AngularJS, Ionic, CGM API integration, low-code insurance platform, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTESTING AND AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A personal crypto backtesting engine and autonomous agent framework built and iterated in public.

- Implements file-queue-based agent loops for autonomous decision steps in trading workflows.
- Architecture uses Python with modular strategy components, designed for extension rather than replacement.
- Active development with hands-on integration of exchange connectivity and execution logic.
- Demonstrates self-directed system design under no external deadline – directly relevant for owning a greenfield platform with an evolving scope.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT SOTALENT

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Attend every PI Planning artefact and stakeholder session available, map what is known versus assumed in the timetable domain, and produce a first-draft dependency register that the Release Train Engineer can immediately react to.

WEEK 2

Slice the backlog.

Take the highest-priority fuzzy Epics from the scope discovery, run a structured refinement session with the architects and backend engineers, and produce the first set of actionable Features with clear acceptance criteria and security considerations flagged.

WEEK 3+

Ship and stabilise.

Maintain sprint discipline with velocity tracking, close dependency loops across the ART, and begin building the transparent delivery roadmap with explicit flexibility buffers for the technical requirements still emerging.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Technical Product Owner role on the transport systems and AI scheduling platform. The combination of a greenfield scope inside a newly forming Agile Release Train and explicit AI integration as a goal is not something I encounter in most Product Owner postings, and it is precisely the kind of situation I have navigated most effectively.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned a central AI and data management platform for the European defence programme FCAS from inception. Requirements were incomplete, the stakeholder landscape was multinational and politically sensitive, and the architecture was evolving in parallel with the backlog I was building. I delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout – and unblocked infrastructure issues independently when engineer bandwidth was unavailable. Reducing deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes through GitOps with ArgoCD

is one concrete artefact of that ownership posture. That is the technical depth and delivery agency I would bring to defining the timetable platform scope from the ground up.

At the Federal Employment Agency I served as Product Manager for a public-sector analytics platform and simultaneously held the deputy IT security officer role. Both the compliance awareness and the institutional communication patterns of a large German public-sector environment are therefore familiar territory for me, not a new context to adapt to. I also hold a Diplom Wirtschaftsingenieur from TU Berlin with a logistics specialisation, which means the domain vocabulary of transport system planning – scheduling, capacity, routing, operational constraints – is a foundation rather than a gap.

The posting specifically calls for experience in scaled agile frameworks. At Emil Group I restructured a bloated 17-person team into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking, and rebuilt delivery stability in an environment where sprint discipline had broken down under client pressure. That is a different manifestation of SAFe-adjacent scaled agile work than a formal ART, but the underlying skills – dependency management across teams, PI-level sequencing, stakeholder expectation management – transfer directly to the environment you are describing.

I work entirely in German professionally and have done so across public-sector clients, government contracts, and regulated industries throughout my career. I am based in Berlin and fully comfortable with the 80 percent remote, one day Frankfurt on-site model.

I would welcome a conversation about the platform architecture that is already in scope and where the backlog work needs to start.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Manager and Product Owner with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into scalable software systems. Built and owned greenfield AI and data platforms in defence and public-sector environments, re-established delivery discipline in scaled Scrum contexts, and held deputy IT security officer responsibility in a regulated public-sector analytics programme. Comfortable operating where requirements are incomplete and stakeholders need structured clarity to move. Fluent in German natively; holds a logistics specialisation from TU Berlin directly relevant to transport system domain reasoning.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Backlog construction from greenfield, fuzzy-to-structured
- SAFe-adjacent scaled agile delivery and sprint discipline
- Technical depth: APIs, platform architecture, DevOps lifecycle
- Cross-functional stakeholder alignment in public-sector contexts
- Dependency management across multiple product teams
- Compliance and IT security awareness (deputy IT-SV experience)
- AI-native product execution and rapid prototyping
- Translating business needs into Epics, Features, and User Stories
- Logistics and transport domain foundations (TU Berlin specialisation)

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned end-to-end delivery of a greenfield AI data management platform for a multinational defence programme (FCAS), building backlog, Epics, and Features from an evolving scope with no established baseline
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD; unblocked OpenShift infrastructure issues independently
- Led cross-functional team spanning architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated datasets with transparent evaluation concepts (SafeAI, ExplainableAI) and full data provenance audit trails

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Advanced a public-sector analytics platform (Arbeitsmarktmonitor) for regional labour market data with complex compliance and governance requirements
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV): compliance, governance, data lineage
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration

- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Restructured a bloated 17-person team into focused Scrum units; reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices
- Restored delivery stability and sprint discipline in a scaled environment under sustained client pressure
- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation from concept to production
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured weekly product workshops

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient-facing flows under tight deadlines with strict prioritisation of highest-leverage features
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity involving legacy APIs and external hospital databases
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows on iOS and Android

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

- **Qcrypt AG (2016–2018), Product Owner:** Quantum-secure encryption product (OTP, true-RNG hardware). Owned backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture. Deputy IT security officer.
- **Kvitt Payment Solutions (2013–2018), Founder & CFO:** Group-based P2P payments; PSP integration, full UX/UI design, mobile app prototype. Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse.
- **Smart Soil Technologies (2016–2021), Co-Founder / CFO / CDO & Head of HR:** Digital tooling, financial planning, ERP introduction, investor relations across multiple phases.
- **Bundesdruckerei / COVID-19 Data Platform (2021), Product Owner:** RKI projects DIM and DESH; secure data structures and identity management.

- **AOK Health Insurance ITSCare (2019–2020), Proxy Product Owner:** Migration of internal webshop to Shopware with complex catalogue/API integration and customisable approval policies.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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